WP Integration

Building The ELSA Way – a community resource for responsible AI in healthcare

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What are we building (main output)?

Our main output is The ELSA Way: a freely accessible, community-driven online resource that brings together practical knowledge, tools, and guidelines for developing AI responsibly in healthcare. Think of it as a living handbook, one that researchers, developers, and healthcare professionals can contribute to, learn from, and use throughout the entire lifecycle of an AI system.

> *The ELSA Way is a publicly accessible website where researchers, developers, healthcare professionals, patients, and community members can find and contribute practical guidance for developing AI responsibly in healthcare. It is structured around the AI development lifecycle, from data collection and model design through to deployment and monitoring stages. Unlike a static report or policy document, a staged-gated or checklist approach, The ELSA Way is designed as an integrated way of working, embedding ELSA considerations at every phase of the AI lifecycle. It offers frameworks, case studies, and worked examples that teams can draw on. It is continuously updated, so anyone can propose additions, flag gaps, or contribute new content, with an editorial board ensuring quality and consistency.*

To build it, we are:

- Conducting research with AI developers and healthcare professionals to understand what guidance they actually need, through surveys, interviews, and co-creation workshops and simulations.
- Publishing our findings in peer-reviewed papers, presenting our findings in scientific conferences and translating them into practical contributions to The ELSA Way.
- Building the governance and training infrastructure that will allow The ELSA Way to grow and remain trustworthy over time, including the use of GitHub as an open collaborative platform, enabling contributors to propose, discuss, and review content improvements.
- Develop concrete mechanisms for patient engagement, such as participatory design methods, patient advisory input and accessible contribution pathways.
- Contributing to a MOOC for UMCG healthcare professionals developed across all ELSA-NN working packages, which can serve as a foundation for The ELSA Way.
- Connecting with other ELSA labs and the broader national ELSA community, drawing on shared methods and expertise, co-shaping the shared language and conceptual frameworks, and strengthening the breadth and rigour of The ELSA Way's content.

What impact do we aim to achieve?

We want to make it easier for people building AI in healthcare to do it responsibly. Right now, there is a gap: developers, healthcare professionals, and institutions want to address ethical, legal and societal concerns of AI in their work, but practical, accessible guidance is hard to find. The ELSA Way aims to close that gap.

By making knowledge freely available and community-maintained, we aim to:

- Give AI developers in healthcare a practical, go-to reference for responsible design across the full AI lifecycle.
- Help healthcare professionals understand, engage with, and critically evaluate AI systems in their care environment.
- Ensure that patients and communities have a voice in how AI is developed and applied by making their perspectives, needs, and concerns a visible and valued part of the resource.
- Create shared language and shared tools that reduce fragmentation across the responsible AI field.

> *The ELSA Way is a work in progress, and that is by design. It grows as we learn, and it improves as more people contribute. The goal is not a finished product, but a living resource that stays relevant.*

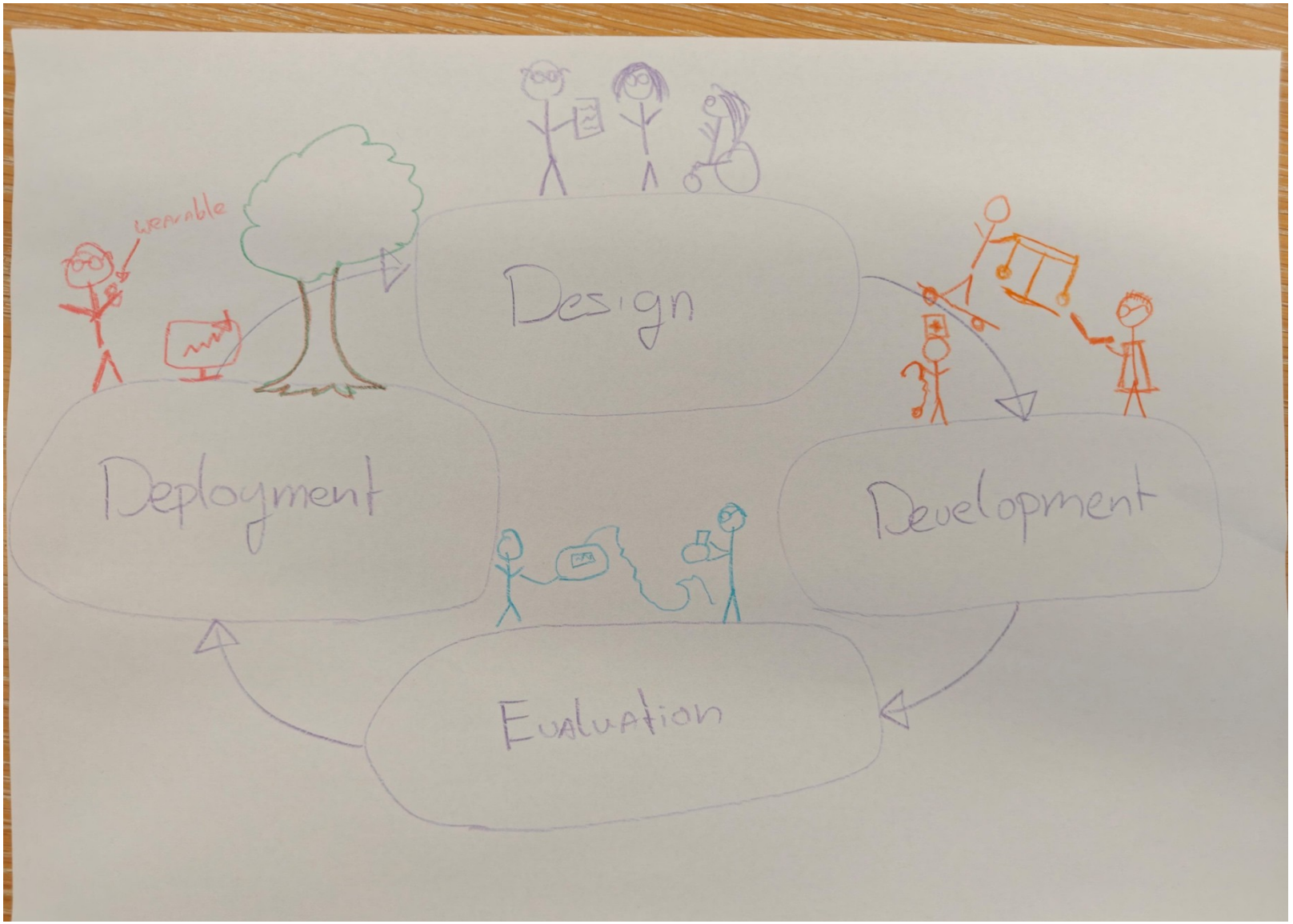
How does this contribute to responsible AI in healthcare and the ELSA-NN mission?

The ELSA-NN exists to develop knowledge about responsible AI in healthcare and translate it into practice. WP Integration does exactly that: it takes the knowledge generated across all working packages and use-cases and turns it into something usable and accessible.

The ELSA Way embodies the values of the ELSA-NN:

- **Open and collaborative**: built in the open, with contributions from researchers, practitioners, and communities across the network.
- **Centred on people**: developed with and for those most affected by AI in healthcare, including patients and the broader community, not only those who build or deploy these systems.
- **Inclusive**: designed to be accessible to people with different roles and levels of technical expertise, including those often excluded from AI development conversations.
- **Accountable**: governed transparently, with clear roles, contribution guidelines, and version history.

By ensuring that all working packages and use-cases can contribute, by connecting to other ELSA labs beyond healthcare, and by being open to the community, the ELSA Way can grow into a shared infrastructure that serves the entire network, and eventually, the broader field.


wearable
Design
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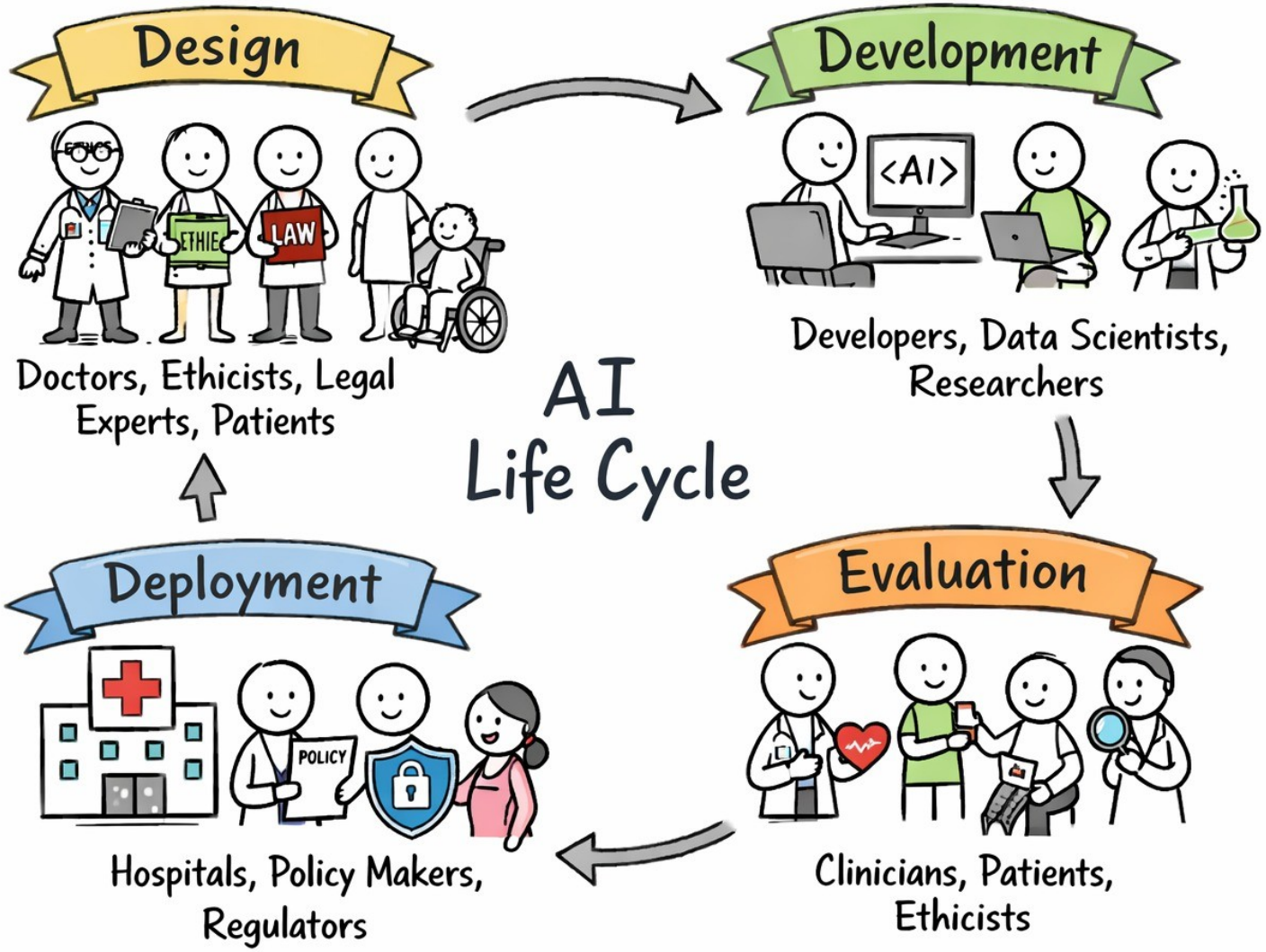
Design
ETHICS
ETHIC
LAW
Doctors, Ethicists, Legal Experts, Patients
Development
<AI>
Developers, Data Scientists, Researchers
AI Life Cycle
Evaluation
Clinicians, Patients, Ethicists
Deployment
POLICY
Hospitals, Policy Makers, Regulators